Edamame, or fresh soy beans, are widely available as frozen whole pods from Asian supermarkets—thaw them slightly before using.

edamame noodle soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 10 MINS **COOK** 10 MINS **FREEZE** NOT SUITABLE

1lb 2oz (500g) edamame in the pod or 8oz (225g) shelled weight
4 tbsp white miso paste
14oz (400g) cooked udon noodles
1 tbsp brown sugar, or to taste
juice of 1 lemon

for the hot garlic oil
1 small hot red chile, snipped
1 clove garlic
½ tsp coarse sea salt
2 tbsp sesame oil

1 Remove the edamame from the pod, if necessary, and set aside. Bring 1 quart (1 liter) of water to a boil in a large pot. Meanwhile, make the hot garlic oil. With a mortar and pestle, pound the chile, garlic, and salt together until smooth, then stir in the sesame oil.

2 Place the miso in a small bowl and mix with 2–3 tbsp of boiling water from the pan, stirring until you have a pourable paste. Add the edamame, noodles, and sugar to the water in the pan and cook for 3 minutes, or until the edamame are tender but still bright green.

3 Turn off the heat and stir in the diluted miso paste, then add lemon juice to taste. Ladle into warm bowls and drizzle with the hot garlic oil before serving.